UNIVERSITY OF SINDH

JAMSHORO SINDH, PAKISTAN

B. Ed. 04 Year

Course No. EFMP-406 Credit Hours **3**

Title of Course : **Contemporary Literacy** Semester : 3rd

Course Description

This course is designed to develop an understanding of contemporary perspectives on literacy in the context of rapid social, cultural, and technological change. It emphasizes literacy as a socially situated practice and extends beyond traditional reading and writing to include critical, digital, media, visual, and information literacies. The course prepares prospective teachers to design, implement, and evaluate literacy practices that address diverse learners and meet the demands of 21st-century education in alignment with national and international standards.

Learning Outcomes:

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

1. Define and explain the concept and scope of contemporary literacy.
2. Differentiate between traditional and modern perspectives of literacy.
3. Analyze the role of literacy in social, cultural, and digital contexts.
4. Apply contemporary literacy teaching strategies in classroom settings.
5. Design literacy activities that promote critical thinking and learner engagement.

Course Outline

Unit 1: **Concept and Evolution of Literacy**

- Meaning and nature of literacy
- Traditional and contemporary views of literacy
- Historical development of literacy practices
- Literacy as a lifelong learning process

Unit 2: Contemporary Forms of Literacy

- Critical literacy
- Digital literacy
- Media and information literacy
- Visual and multimodal literacy

Unit 3: Literacy, Language, and Society

- Literacy as a social and cultural practice
- Language, identity, and power relations
- Literacy for citizenship and democratic participation
- Multilingualism and literacy development

Unit 4: Literacy in the Digital Era

- Technology and literacy development
- Digital reading and writing practices
- Online communication and social media
- Ethical, legal, and responsible use of digital resources

Unit 5: Pedagogical Approaches to Contemporary Literacy

- Learner-centered literacy instruction
- Inquiry-based and project-based learning
- Integration of ICT in literacy teaching

- Assessment and evaluation of literacy skills

Unit 6: Issues, Challenges, and Future Directions

- Literacy challenges in developing contexts
- Equity, access, and inclusion in literacy education
- Role of teachers in promoting contemporary literacy
- Future trends in literacy education

Teaching–Learning Strategies:

- Group discussions and seminars
- Role-plays and simulations
- Case study analysis
- Visits to inclusive schools
- Reflection journals and portfolios

Assessment & Evaluation:

- Class participation and reflective journals – 10%
- Mid-term written test – 20%
- Project: Developing an inclusive lesson plan – 30%
- Final exam (written + presentation) – 40%

Recommended Books / References:

1. Booth, T., &Ainscow, M. (2016). *The Index for Inclusion: Developing Learning and Participation in Schools.*
2. Mittler, P. (2019). *Working Towards Inclusive Education.*Routledge.
3. Loreman, T., Deppeler, J., & Harvey, D. (2020). *Inclusive Education: Supporting Diversity in the Classroom.*
4. UNESCO (2017). *A Guide for Ensuring Inclusion and Equity in Education.*
5. Government of Pakistan (2018). *National Education Policy Framework.* Islamabad: MoFEPT.

TEACHING/INSTRUCTIONAL STRATEGIES

This course will be covered with the help of following teaching strategies

1. Lecture
2. Discussions
3. Question-Answer
4. Brain storming

PRACTICAL WORK

The student-teachers will also complete their course with the help of following practical work.

1. Group work
2. Group assignments
3. Individual assignment
4. Presentations

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

The students will be assessed through,

1. Class test
2. Mid Term test
3. Evaluation of assignments
4. Class attendance
5. Class participation/Performance e.g. initiative, responding, curiosity, inquiry